

90% COMPLETE

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L2. Working After Graduating

Graduates from the EU, European Economic Area or Switzerland can stay in France as long as they like after graduation to look for work.

Non-EU/EEA students on the VLS-TS *étudiant* visa graduating from French higher education institutions can work in France after completing their studies if they have a promise of employment in a job that pays at least 1.5 times the minimum wage. This applies to students graduating with bachelor's, master's, or doctoral degrees. Currently the minimum wage in France is EUR 10,03/hour gross or EUR 1525.47/month gross, which means students need to be paid at least EUR 15.05/hour gross or EUR 2281.82/month to be able to stay on in France.

If they do not have a promise of employment, international students graduating with a master's, professional bachelor's degree (*Licence professionnelle*) or post-graduate degree (e.g., a PhD) can apply for a non-renewable **one-year** *Autorisation Provisoire de Séjour* (APS) temporary residence permit. This permit allows students to stay in France to look for a full-time job or to start a business.

A full list of degrees that qualify for the *recherche d'emploi/création d'entreprise* permit can be found [here](#).

Students with master's and approved other degrees obtained at French higher education institutions who have left France after their studies to are permitted to apply for the ***recherche d'emploi/création d'entreprise* permit** up to four years after graduation.

There are certain beneficial conditions (sometimes including being able to stay for longer than one year) attached to the *recherche d'emploi/création d'entreprise* permit permits for students from countries with bilateral

agreements with France (e.g., Senegal, Gabon, Benin, Tunisia, Mauritius, Cape Verde, Burkina Faso, Cameroon, Macedonia, Montenegro, Serbia, Lebanon and India. Students from these countries should consult the website of the **Ministry of Internal Affairs** or contact the **Campus France Office** in their country for more information.

In addition, Indian students who have graduated with a master's or PhD from a French higher education institution may be able to obtain a **post-study work visa** lasting up to five years.

While they seek full-time employment, students with a *recherche d'emploi/création d'entreprise* permit can work in any job part-time (up to 60% of full-time hours). Those who find a job that pays at least 1.5 times the minimum wage can switch their immigration status from "student" to "employee" or "temporary worker."

The temporary worker permit is valid for one year. At the end of that term, it is possible to request a "general, multi-annual residence permit for 'employees' for a period of four years."

There are also work and immigration possibilities for certain students under the **"Talent Passport."** Researchers who have been in France on this passport obtain a residency permit valid for the same period of time that was specified under their hosting agreement for up to four years. This process is renewable. Please visit the **Euraxess** website for more information.

Campus France has a **webpage** that students can consult for advice about looking for work while in France.

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